Text 1

同伴压力能否成为社会疗法

第 1 段

Come on—Everybody's doing it. That whispered message, half invitation and half forcing, is what most of us think of when we hear the words peer pressure. It usually leads to no good—drinking, drugs and casual sex. But in her new book Join the Club, Tina Rosenberg contends that peer pressure can also be a positive force through what she calls the social cure, in which organizations and officials use the power of group dynamics to help individuals improve their lives and possibly the world.

‘来吧 —— 大家都在这么做。’每当听到‘同伴压力’这个词，我们大多数人想到的，就是这种半是邀请、半是逼迫的低声劝说。它通常不会带来什么好事 —— 喝酒、吸毒以及随意的性行为。但在新书《加入这个群体》中，蒂娜 · 罗森伯格认为，通过她所说的‘社会疗法’，同伴压力也可以成为积极力量；在这种疗法中，组织和官员利用群体互动的力量，帮助个人改善生活，并可能改善世界。

第 2 段

Rosenberg, the recipient of a Pulitzer Prize, offers a host of examples of the social cure in action: In South Carolina, a state-sponsored antismoking program called Rage Against the Haze sets out to make cigarettes uncool. In South Africa, an HIV-prevention initiative known as loveLife recruits young people to promote safe sex among their peers.

普利策奖得主罗森伯格举出了许多社会疗法实际发挥作用的例子：在南卡罗来纳州，一个由州政府资助、名为‘对抗烟雾’的禁烟项目，着手让吸烟变得不酷。在南非，一项名为 loveLife 的艾滋病预防计划招募年轻人，让他们在同龄人中推广安全性行为。

第 3 段

The idea seems promising, and Rosenberg is a perceptive observer. Her critique of the lameness of many public-health campaigns is spot-on: they fail to mobilize peer pressure for healthy habits, and they demonstrate a seriously flawed understanding of psychology. “Dare to be different, please don't smoke!” pleads one billboard campaign aimed at reducing smoking among teenagers — teenagers, who desire nothing more than fitting in. Rosenberg argues convincingly that public-health advocates ought to take a page from advertisers, so skilled at applying peer pressure.

这个想法似乎很有前景，而且罗森伯格是个观察敏锐的人。她对许多公共卫生宣传活动无力之处的批评十分准确：这些活动未能调动同伴压力来促进健康习惯，而且表现出对心理学的理解存在严重缺陷。一项旨在减少青少年吸烟的广告牌宣传恳求道：‘敢于与众不同，请不要吸烟！’然而，青少年最渴望的恰恰是融入群体。罗森伯格令人信服地指出，公共卫生倡导者应当向那些善于施加同伴压力的广告商学习。

第 4 段

But on the general effectiveness of the social cure, Rosenberg is less persuasive. Join the Club is filled with too much irrelevant detail and not enough exploration of the social and biological factors that make peer pressure so powerful. The most glaring flaw of the social cure as it's presented here is that it doesn't work very well for very long. Rage Against the Haze failed once state funding was cut. Evidence that the loveLife program produces lasting changes is limited and mixed.

但是，在社会疗法的总体有效性方面，罗森伯格的论述就不那么有说服力了。《加入这个群体》充斥着过多无关的细节，却没有充分探讨那些使同伴压力如此强大的社会和生物因素。书中所呈现的社会疗法最突出的缺陷，是它无法长期保持良好效果。州政府资金一旦被削减，‘对抗烟雾’项目就失败了。而能够证明 loveLife 项目带来持久改变的证据，不仅有限，而且结果不一。

第 5 段

There's no doubt that our peer groups exert enormous influence on our behavior. An emerging body of research shows that positive health habits —as well as negative ones — spread through networks of friends via social communication. This is a subtle form of peer pressure: we unconsciously imitate the behavior we see every day.

毫无疑问，同伴群体对我们的行为有巨大的影响。越来越多的研究表明，积极的健康习惯和消极的健康习惯一样，会通过社会交往在朋友网络中传播。这是一种微妙的同伴压力：我们会无意识地模仿每天看到的行为。

第 6 段

Far less certain, however, is how successfully experts and bureaucrats can select our peer groups and steer their activities in virtuous directions. It's like the teacher who breaks up the troublemakers in the back row by pairing them with better-behaved classmates. The tactic never really works. And that's the problem with a social cure engineered from the outside: in the real world, as in school, we insist on choosing our own friends.

然而，专家和官员能够多么成功地为我们选择同伴群体，并把这些群体的活动引向良好方向，就远不那么确定了。这就像老师把后排的捣乱学生拆开，让他们与行为更好的同学结对。这种策略实际上总不大奏效。这正是从外部设计出来的社会疗法的问题：在现实世界里，和在学校里一样，我们坚持自己选择朋友。

阅读分析

作者认可同伴影响真实存在，也赞同罗森伯格对传统宣传的部分批评；但对外部组织能否有效操控同伴关系、形成持久健康改善持保留态度。

直译提示

第 3 段 desire nothing more than fitting in 意为‘最渴望融入群体’；末段质疑的是外部设计的疗法，并非否认一切同伴影响。

Text 2

核电企业的承诺与公共信任

第 1 段

A deal is a deal—except, apparently, when Entergy is involved. The company, a major energy supplier in New England, provoked justified outrage in Vermont last week when it announced it was reneging on a longstanding commitment to abide by the state's strict nuclear regulations.

协议就是协议 —— 不过，显然一旦涉及安特吉公司，就成了例外。上周，这家新英格兰地区的主要能源供应商宣布，它将违背长期以来遵守佛蒙特州严格核能监管规定的承诺，因此在该州激起了理所当然的愤怒。

第 2 段

Instead, the company has done precisely what it had long promised it would not: challenge the constitutionality of Vermont's rules in the federal court, as part of a desperate effort to keep its Vermont Yankee nuclear power plant running. It's a stunning move.

相反，这家公司恰恰做了它长期承诺不会做的事：在联邦法院挑战佛蒙特州规定的合宪性，作为其不惜一切努力让佛蒙特扬基核电站继续运营的一部分。这是一个令人震惊的举动。

第 3 段

The conflict has been surfacing since 2002, when the corporation bought Vermont's only nuclear power plant, an aging reactor in Vernon. As a condition of receiving state approval for the sale, the company agreed to seek permission from state regulators to operate past 2012. In 2006, the state went a step further, requiring that any extension of the plant's license be subject to the Vermont legislature's approval. Then, too, the company went along.

这场冲突自 2002 年起就开始浮现；当时，该公司购买了佛蒙特州唯一的核电站，也就是位于弗农的一座老化反应堆。作为获得州政府批准这笔交易的条件，公司同意，如果要在 2012 年之后继续运营，必须向州监管机构寻求许可。2006 年，该州又进一步规定，核电站许可证的任何延期都必须获得佛蒙特州立法机关批准。当时，公司也同意了。

第 4 段

Either Entergy never really intended to live by those commitments, or it simply didn't foresee what would happen next. A string of accidents, including the partial collapse of a cooling tower in 2007 and the discovery of an underground pipe system leakage, raised serious questions about both Vermont Yankee's safety and Entergy's management— especially after the company made misleading statements about the pipe. Enraged by Entergy's behavior, the Vermont Senate voted 26 to 4 last year against allowing an extension.

要么安特吉从未真正打算遵守这些承诺，要么它只是没有预见到接下来会发生什么。一连串事故，包括 2007 年冷却塔部分坍塌以及发现地下管道系统泄漏，使人们对佛蒙特扬基核电站的安全和安特吉的管理都产生了严重质疑，尤其是在公司就管道问题作出误导性陈述之后。佛蒙特州参议院被安特吉的行为激怒，去年以 26 票对 4 票的结果反对批准延期。

第 5 段

Now the company is suddenly claiming that the 2002 agreement is invalid because of the 2006 legislation, and that only the federal government has regulatory power over nuclear issues. The legal issues in the case are obscure: whereas the Supreme Court has ruled that states do have some regulatory authority over nuclear power, legal scholars say the Vermont case will offer a precedent-setting test of how far those powers extend. Certainly, there are valid concerns about the patchwork regulations that could result if every state sets its own rules. But had Entergy kept its word, that debate would be beside the point.

现在，公司突然声称，由于 2006 年的立法，2002 年的协议无效，而且只有联邦政府才拥有核事务监管权。这个案件的法律问题并不明朗：尽管最高法院已经裁定各州确实对核能拥有一定的监管权，法律学者仍认为，佛蒙特州案件将提供一次能够确立先例的检验，以确定这些权力究竟延伸到什么程度。当然，如果每个州都制定自己的规则，可能造成杂乱不一的监管规定，对此的担忧是有道理的。但是，如果安特吉信守了自己的诺言，那场争论就不会成为问题的重点。

第 6 段

The company seems to have concluded that its reputation in Vermont is already so damaged that it has nothing left to lose by going to war with the state. But there should be consequences. Permission to run a nuclear plant is a public trust. Entergy runs 11 other reactors in the United States, including Pilgrim Nuclear station in Plymouth. Pledging to run Pilgrim safely, the company has applied for federal permission to keep it open for another 20 years. But as the Nuclear Regulatory Commission (NRC) reviews the company's application, it should keep in mind what promises from Entergy are worth.

公司似乎已经得出结论：它在佛蒙特州的声誉已经受损到如此程度，以至于向该州开战也没有什么可再失去的了。但是，这种行为应该有后果。运营核电站的许可是一项公众托付。安特吉还在美国运营着另外十一座反应堆，其中包括普利茅斯的朝圣者核电站。公司承诺安全运营朝圣者核电站，并已向联邦政府申请许可，希望让其再运行二十年。但是，当美国核管理委员会（NRC）审查公司的申请时，它应当记住安特吉的承诺究竟值多少。

阅读分析

作者以安特吉违背监管承诺为中心展开批评。州与联邦权限虽然复杂，文章的评价重心仍是企业信用和公共托付，而不是替法院解决法律争议。

直译提示

第 5 段 had Entergy kept its word 是 If Entergy had kept its word 的倒装虚拟条件；末句 what promises ... are worth 带有讽刺性的质疑。

Text 3

科学发现如何获得可信性

第 1 段

In the idealized version of how science is done, facts about the world are waiting to be observed and collected by objective researchers who use the scientific method to carry out their work. But in the everyday practice of science, discovery frequently follows an ambiguous and complicated route. We aim to be objective, but we cannot escape the context of our unique life experiences. Prior knowledge and interests influence what we experience, what we think our experiences mean, and the subsequent actions we take. Opportunities for misinterpretation, error, and self-deception abound.

在有关科学如何开展的理想化描述中，关于世界的事实正等待客观的研究者去观察和收集；这些研究者使用科学方法开展工作。但是，在日常科学实践中，发现常常沿着一条模糊而复杂的道路前进。我们力求客观，却无法摆脱自身独特生活经历构成的背景。已有知识和兴趣会影响我们经历什么、如何理解自己的经历，以及随后采取什么行动。误解、错误和自我欺骗的机会到处都是。

第 2 段

Consequently, discovery claims should be thought of as protoscience. Similar to newly staked mining claims, they are full of potential. But it takes collective scrutiny and acceptance to transform a discovery claim into a mature discovery. This is the credibility process, through which the individual researcher's me, here, now becomes the community's anyone, anywhere, anytime. Objective knowledge is the goal, not the starting point.

因此，对某项发现的主张，应当被视为尚处萌芽阶段的科学。它们类似于新圈定的矿产开采权主张，充满潜力。但是，要把一项发现主张转化为成熟的发现，需要集体的审查和认可。这就是可信性形成过程：通过这一过程，个别研究者的‘我、这里、现在’，变成科学共同体的‘任何人、任何地方、任何时候’。客观知识是目标，而不是起点。

第 3 段

Once a discovery claim becomes public, the discoverer receives intellectual credit. But, unlike with mining claims, the community takes control of what happens next. Within the complex social structure of the scientific community, researchers make discoveries; editors and reviewers act as gatekeepers by controlling the publication process; other scientists use the new finding to suit their own purposes; and finally, the public (including other scientists) receives the new discovery and possibly accompanying technology. As a discovery claim works its way through the community, the interaction and confrontation between shared and competing beliefs about the science and the technology involved transforms an individual's discovery claim into the community's credible discovery.

一项发现主张一旦公开，发现者就获得相应的学术功劳。但是，与矿权主张不同，接下来发生什么由共同体掌握。在科学共同体复杂的社会结构中，研究者作出发现；编辑和审稿人通过控制发表流程充当把关者；其他科学家利用新发现服务于自己的目的；最后，公众（包括其他科学家）接收到这项新发现，以及可能伴随而来的技术。当一项发现主张在共同体中逐步推进时，围绕相关科学与技术的共同信念和相互竞争的信念之间的互动与交锋，会把个人的发现主张转化为共同体认可的可信发现。

第 4 段

Two paradoxes exist throughout this credibility process. First, scientific work tends to focus on some aspect of prevailing knowledge that is viewed as incomplete or incorrect. Little reward accompanies duplication and confirmation of what is already known and believed. The goal is new-search, not re-search. Not surprisingly, newly published discovery claims and credible discoveries that appear to be important and convincing will always be open to challenge and potential modification or refutation by future researchers. Second, novelty itself frequently provokes disbelief. Nobel Laureate and physiologist Albert Szent-Györgyi once described discovery as "seeing what everybody has seen and thinking what nobody has thought." But thinking what nobody else has thought and telling others what they have missed may not change their views. Sometimes years are required for truly novel discovery claims to be accepted and appreciated.

在整个可信性形成过程中，存在两个悖论。第一，科学工作往往关注现有知识中被视为不完整或不正确的某个方面。重复和确认已经知道且相信的东西，通常获得的回报很少。目标是 ' 探索新知 '，而不是 ' 重复探索 '。因此，刚发表的发现主张以及那些看起来重要而令人信服的可信发现，总会受到未来研究者的质疑，并可能被修改或反驳，这并不奇怪。第二，新颖性本身常常招致怀疑。诺贝尔奖获得者、生理学家阿尔伯特 · 圣捷尔吉曾把发现描述为：' 看到人人都看到的东西，想到无人想到的东西。' 然而，想到别人没有想到的事，并告诉他们遗漏了什么，并不一定能改变他们的看法。有时，真正新颖的发现主张要经过多年，才会被接受和赏识。

第 5 段

In the end, credibility "happens" to a discovery claim—a process that corresponds to what philosopher Annette Baier has described as the commons of the mind. "We reason together, challenge, revise, and complete each other's reasoning and each other's conceptions of reason."

最终，可信性 ' 发生 ' 在一项发现主张身上；这一过程对应于哲学家安妮特 · 拜尔所说的 ' 心智的公共领域 '。' 我们共同推理，互相质疑、修正并完善彼此的推理，以及彼此对理性的理解。'

阅读分析

文章把科学发现看作从个人主张到共同体认可的过程，强调公开、审查、争论与修正。客观性不是未经检验的个人观察自带的属性，而是科学活动追求的目标。

直译提示

第 2 段 me, here, now 与 anyone, anywhere, anytime 对照个体经验和可普遍检验的知识；第 4 段 new-search / re-search 是文字游戏，强调新发现与重复验证的张力。

Text 4

公共部门工会与激励机制

第 1 段

If the trade unionist Jimmy Hoffa were alive today, he would probably represent civil servants. When Hoffa's Teamsters were in their prime in 1960, only one in ten American government workers belonged to a union; now 36% do. In 2009 the number of unionists in America's public sector passed that of their fellow members in the private sector. In Britain, more than half of public-sector workers but only about 15% of private-sector ones are unionized.

如果工会活动家吉米 · 霍法今天还活着，他很可能会代表公务员。当霍法领导的卡车司机工会在 1960 年处于鼎盛时期时，美国政府雇员中只有十分之一加入工会；现在则有 36%。2009 年，美国公共部门的工会会员人数超过了私营部门。在英国，公共部门雇员有一半以上加入工会，而私营部门只有约 15%。

第 2 段

There are three reasons for the public-sector unions' thriving. First, they can shut things down without suffering much in the way of consequences. Second, they are mostly bright and well-educated. A quarter of America's public-sector workers have a university degree. Third, they now dominate left-of-centre politics. Some of their ties go back a long way. Britain's Labor Party, as its name implies, has long been associated with trade unionism. Its current leader, Ed Miliband, owes his position to votes from public-sector unions.

公共部门工会的兴盛有三个原因。第一，它们可以使工作停摆，而自己不必承受多少后果。第二，成员大多聪明且受过良好教育。美国公共部门雇员中有四分之一拥有大学学位。第三，它们如今主导中间偏左的政治力量。它们的一些联系可以追溯到很久以前。正如名称所暗示的那样，英国工党长期以来一直与工会运动密切相关。其现任领袖埃德 · 米利班德的职位，得益于公共部门工会的选票。

第 3 段

At the state level their influence can be even more fearsome. Mark Baldassare of the Public Policy Institute of California points out that much of the state's budget is patrolled by unions. The teachers' unions keep an eye on schools, the CCPOA on prisons and a variety of labor groups on health care.

在州一级，它们的影响甚至可能更加令人畏惧。加利福尼亚公共政策研究所的马克 · 巴尔达萨雷指出，该州预算的很大一部分都受到工会的监控。教师工会盯着学校，加州惩教人员协会（CCPOA）盯着监狱，各种劳工团体则盯着医疗保健。

第 4 段

In many rich countries average wages in the state sector are higher than in the private one. But the real gains come in benefits and work practices. Politicians have repeatedly "backloaded" public-sector pay deals, keeping the pay increases modest but adding to holidays and especially pensions that are already generous.

在许多富裕国家，公共部门的平均工资高于私营部门。但真正的好处体现在福利和工作惯例上。政治家一再把公共部门薪酬协议的收益 ' 后置 ': 控制当前工资增幅，却增加假期，尤其是增加原本就很优厚的养老金。

第 5 段

Reform has been vigorously opposed, perhaps most notoriously in education, where charter schools, academies and merit pay all faced drawn-out battles. Even though there is plenty of evidence that the quality of the teachers is the most important variable, teachers' unions have fought against getting rid of bad ones and promoting good ones.

改革一直受到强烈反对，最为人诟病的情况或许出现在教育领域：特许学校、学院型学校和绩效工资都面临旷日持久的斗争。尽管有大量证据表明，教师质量是最重要的变量，教师工会却一直反对淘汰差教师和提拔好教师。

第 6 段

As the cost to everyone else has become clearer, politicians have begun to clamp down. In Wisconsin the unions have rallied thousands of supporters against Scott Walker, the hardline Republican governor. But many within the public sector suffer under the current system, too.

随着其他所有人所承担的成本越来越清楚，政治家开始采取强硬限制措施。在威斯康星州，工会召集了数千名支持者，反对强硬的共和党州长斯科特 · 沃克。但公共部门内部的许多人，也在现行制度下受苦。

第 7 段

John Donahue at Harvard's Kennedy School points out that the norms of culture in Western civil services suit those who want to stay put but is bad for high achievers. The only American public-sector workers who earn well above $250,000 a year are university sports coaches and the president of the United States. Bankers' fat pay packets have attracted much criticism, but a public-sector system that does not reward high achievers may be a much bigger problem for America.

哈佛大学肯尼迪学院的约翰 · 多纳休指出，西方公务员体系的文化规范适合那些想安于原位的人，却不利于表现出色者。美国公共部门中，年收入远高于 25 万美元的人，只有大学体育教练和美国总统。银行家丰厚的薪酬引来了许多批评，但一个不奖励优秀人才的公共部门制度，对美国而言可能是一个大得多的问题。

阅读分析

文章先解释公共部门工会的力量来源，再讨论其阻碍改革的表现，最后把问题推进到激励机制：僵化体系不仅让公众付出成本，也可能压制公共部门中的优秀人才。

直译提示

末段 those who want to stay put 与 high achievers 构成对照；作者以银行高薪作比较，是为了突出公共部门缺少绩效激励的问题。